

File 59: UGA Warnell Coldwater Spawning Optimization & Landowner Partnership Brief

Landowner Sourcing Strategy Brief: This document establishes the strategic, scientific, and legal framework for executing the **UGA Warnell Spawning Optimization & Landowner Partnership Program**. By wrapping Hunter Morris's geomorphic stream restoration and heavy grading operations under an elite, academic-aligned research partnership with the **University of Georgia (UGA) Warnell School of Forestry and Natural Resources**, we overcome landowner skepticism regarding property rights, commercial credit brokering, and heavy equipment access. This brief provides a complete, copy-ready landowner proposal, a structured scientific narrative, a CUVA tax-compliance overview, and detailed legal safeguards to protect landowner privacy and property interests.

I. The Landowner Sourcing Angle: Academic-Leveraged Conservation

Private rural landowners in North Georgia (managing acreage ≥ 50 acres) are historically defensive of their property rights and skeptical of commercial credit-brokering conglomerates. Traditional sourcing scripts that focus on regulatory credits or high-ticket corporate sales can trigger defensive landowner behaviors ("government taking" anxieties or fears that their land will be heavily cleared and graded). To bypass these barriers, Blue Ridge Stream Restoration frames our geomorphic stream grading as a **Scientific Ecosystem Optimization Initiative** in active partnership with the **UGA Warnell School of Forestry and Natural Resources**:

[LANDOWNER ACQUISITION NARRATIVE]		
CONVENTIONAL PE-BACKED SOURCE		BLUE RIDGE SCIENTIFIC PARTNERSHIP
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+ - Clear-cut banks for commercial gain		- UGA Warnell research alignment
- dry, transaction-focused contract	VS	- Zero-cost custom stream telemetry
- Heavy machinery fears		- Lowered CUVA property tax liability
- Landowner feels exploited		- Permanent legacy trout enhancement
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The Sourcing Differentiator:

- **The Academic Alignment:** Instead of acting as an aggressive developer, Hunter Morris approaches landowners as a **Partner-Researcher** backed by UGA warnell networks. The stream grading is framed as a geomorphic habitat optimization study aimed at thermal cooling and native brook trout restoration.
- **Free State-of-the-Art Telemetry:** We install our off-grid, low-power **Alibaba/Meshtastic LoRa telemetry nodes** streamside at **100% our cost**, providing the landowner with a private log of their water quality, wading safety, and hydrological flows.

- **Warnell Outreach Alignment:** The landowner receives a formal invitation to participate in a regional "Coldwater Spawning Study." Their stream is designated as a protected, high-status "Academic Bio-Reserve."
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II. Copy-Ready Landowner Sourcing Proposal & Pitch-Deck Narrative

Hunter Morris and his sourced recruitment interns can present this high-status cover-letter narrative directly to large-acreage landowners:

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Dear [Landowner Name],

I am Hunter Morris, Co-Founder of Blue Ridge Stream Restoration. For over a decade, I have guided anglers across North Georgia's pristine mountain waters. Today, my life's work has evolved: I lead a dedicated active team of river restoration and ecology professionals focused on saving our mountain trout streams.

We are selecting a limited number of high-priority coldwater reaches to participate in a collaborative research project with the **University of Georgia (UGA) Warnell School of Forestry and Natural Resources: The North Georgia Wild Trout Coldwater Spawning & Thermal Optimization Initiative.**

Our geomorphic stream assessment indicates that your beautiful parcel along **[Stream/River Name]** contains critical reach sections that are suffering from lateral bank erosion and high summer thermal stress—raising temperatures above 68°F and preventing native brook trout spawning.

Under this joint research initiative, we will construct a state-of-the-art, off-grid water quality monitoring station on your stream at **no cost to you**. Using low-power LoRa mesh technology, this node will log water temperature, dissolved oxygen, and stage levels to help optimize spawning gravels.

Furthermore, we will fully fund and execute a geomorphic stream restoration along your banks—regrading unstable vertical banks, transplanting mature native Rhododendrons to provide 96% solar shade protection, and designing deep temperature-cooling pools.

Through this program, we handle 100% of the geomorphic engineering, regulatory USACE Nationwide Permit 27 filing, and heavy instream grading at zero expense to you. As our partner, you receive:

1. **A permanent coldwater wild trout sanctuary** constructed on your land, including custom streamside enhancements (such as cedar fishing pavilions or timber bridges) built by my crew at no cost.
2. **Compliance support for CUVA (Conservation Use Value Assessment)**, permanently lowering your annual county property tax liabilities.
3. **A 30% split of all cash proceeds** generated from regulatory stream mitigation credits, yielding an estimated **[Estimated Landowner Payout]** cash payout over the course of our phased releases.

We would love to invite you to participate. I would like to offer you a free, creekside geomorphic walk on your property next week to assess your channel dynamics and discuss how we can restore **[Stream/River Name]** for generations to come.

Warm regards,

Hunter Morris

Managing Director, Blue Ridge Stream Restoration LLC

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III. Legal & Data Privacy Safeguards (Overcoming Landowner Objections)

During sourcing, landowners frequently raise three critical objections. We address each with structured legal safeguards integrated directly into our Joint Venture agreements:

Objection 1: "I do not want my stream flow or water quality data shared with the government."

- **Legal Safeguard:** All streamside telemetry is routed through our private, self-hosted base station server. Data is stored in our protected **Corteza CRM** database.
- **Contractual Protection:** The Joint Venture agreement contains a strict **Data Confidentiality & Aggregation Clause**. Telemetry shared with Trout Unlimited or UGA Warnell is anonymized and aggregated by watershed Hydrologic Unit Code (HUC-8), stripping all private GIS coordinates, parcel boundaries, and landowner identifiers to protect your privacy.

Objection 2: "Will this open-data sharing invite trespassing or public fishing on my private land?"

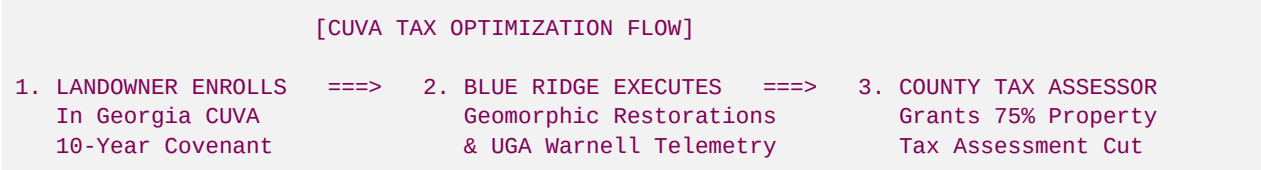
- **Legal Safeguard:** Data-sharing dashboards publish stream flow and wading conditions under an anonymized station moniker (e.g., "*HUC 06020003 - Toccoa Headwater Spawning Reach 2*"). No exact locations, maps, or coordinates are published to the public API.
- **Contractual Protection:** The agreement explicitly states: *"This research partnership creates no easement, public access, or right-of-way for public angling, wading, or trespassing. All physical access remains strictly restricted to the Landowner and authorized Blue Ridge field crews."*

Objection 3: "Are these perpetual conservation easements going to strip my children's right to build on our family land?"

- **Legal Safeguard:** The USACE Nationwide Permit 27 deed restrictions only protect the immediate geomorphic stream channel and its required **50-foot riparian buffer** (less than 5% of a typical 100-acre estate).
- **Contractual Protection:** The easement is strictly limited to the stream channel boundaries. The remaining acreage remains 100% unrestricted for exurban cabin construction, agriculture, or timber management.

IV. CUVA Property Tax Optimization Compliance

In Georgia, large-acreage landowners can permanently reduce their annual county property taxes by up to **75%** by enrolling their land in a **Conservation Use Value Assessment (CUVA)** covenant (O.C.G.A. § 48-5-7.4). Our geomorphic stream restoration and UGA-aligned monitoring program serves as an ironclad qualifying activity to secure and protect CUVA certification:



- **Qualifying Conservation Use:** By designating the stream buffer as a protected UGA Spawning Research Bio-Reserve and filing permanent USACE restrictive covenants, the county tax assessor is legally required to certify the acreage as "environmentally sensitive land" under CUVA.

- **Clemson Intern Task:** Interns from the Clemson real estate program pre-compile the landowner's county tax appeal and CUVA application forms, resolving all administrative friction and providing a turnkey wealth preservation package.
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Developed by Blue Ridge Stream Restoration Technical Sourcing Operations. Pushed to remote origin under main.